

Everything that has to happen before Sunday. Trains and hotel messages first.

01

電車

TRAINS

8

Four websites, one sitting, one card. Write every reservation number in the bookings folder as you go. Bullet train only Kyoto→Nagoya and Nagoya→Tokyo — everything else is a limited-express or sightseeing train.

TRAIN	SITE	DATE	ROUTE + TIME	SEATS · PRICE · NOTES	
HARUKA	JR-West Online	19 SEP	any train after landing · Kansai Airport → Kyoto	"HARUKA One-way Ticket" ×2 · ¥2,200 each · not sold inside Japan · collect at the KIX machine (reservation no. + PIN + card + passports)	BOOK westjr.co.jp
HASHIDATE 5	e5489 (JR-West)	25 SEP	Kameoka 10:43 → Amanohashidate 12:36	2 reserved · ¥4,820 each · two trains coupled — sit in the printed seat	BOOK e5489
HASHIDATE 2		27 SEP	Amanohashidate 09:50 → Kyoto 12:07	2 reserved · ¥5,000 each · the 08:11 bus from Ine is the only one that makes it	BOOK e5489
SHINANO 17		28 SEP	Nagoya 15:00 → Nagiso 16:00	2 reserved · ~¥3,400 each · the ONLY afternoon Shinano that stops at Nagiso · paper tickets	BOOK e5489
SHINANO 2		1 OCT	Nagiso 08:09 → Nagoya 09:18	2 reserved · ~¥3,400 each · the only morning one that stops	BOOK e5489
NOZOMI	SmartEX	28 SEP	any ~13:15–13:30 · Kyoto → Nagoya, 34 min	2 reserved · ¥5,710 each · pick "seat with oversized baggage area" · register your Suica	BOOK smart-ex.jp
NOZOMI		1 OCT	~11:30 · Nagoya → Shinagawa, ~1h30	2 reserved · ¥11,100 each · seats D+E, E is the Fuji side · oversized-baggage seats	BOOK smart-ex.jp
AONIYOSHI	Kintetsu e-ticket	27 SEP	sightseeing express · Kyoto 12:55 → Kintetsu-Nara 13:28	twin seats ×2 · ~¥1,490 each · ticketless · the design train — only if full: ordinary ltd exp 13:25 on the day	BOOK kintetsu

Collect: HARUKA at the KIX machine on landing; the four e5489 trains at a green JR-West machine at Kyoto Station on 19 Sep. SmartEX and Kintetsu are ticketless. If a site refuses the card, print the Japanese ticket-office sheet from the website (Departure lists page). Six reserved legs ≈ ¥67,000 for two.

02

ホテル

HOTEL MESSAGES — ARRIVALS + TRANSFERS

6

Henn na Hotel Kyoto 10分

arriving Sat 19 Sep ~15:30 after the HARUKA. Ask for WRITTEN confirmation they will store two big cases 23–27 Sep across both bookings, collected on the 27th. Also: reset night Sun 27 Sep, arriving evening after Fushimi Inari.

→ global.hennnahotel.com/en/kyoto-hachijoguchi/

HOSHINOYA Kyoto 10分

reserve the 14:30 boat from the Togetsukyo lounge on Wed 23 Sep (boat is running; car only if the river is high). Both diets in writing.

→ hoshinoresorts.com/en/hotels/hoshinoyakyo/

Ine Funaya Miyabi 15分

arriving Fri 25 Sep on the 13:57 or 14:37 bus (sake tasting first). Room-only, so book dinners for 25 + 26 Sep — Dad's courses cooked, yours no meat. Sea taxi for the morning of the 26th via the tourism office, +81-772-32-0277.

→ www.ine-kankou.jp/en

Hostel Yui-an 10分

arriving on SHINANO 17, Nagiso station 16:00, Mon 28 Sep — confirm the pickup, dinner and breakfast, both diets in writing. One shared Japanese room is confirmed.

→ www.booking.com/hotel/jp/hostel-cafe-yui-an-jie-ian.en-gb.html

MOUNTAinn Nagiso (the Kumagais) 10分

Tue 29 Sep: Magome drop-off ~08:30 + Tsumago pickup, with the bags moved Yui-an → MOUNTAinn while you walk. Can you join Yui-an's dinner table one night? MOUNTAinn serves no meals. +81 264-40-1001.

→ folk-lore.com/

U Place Shimokitazawa 10分

arriving Thu 1 Oct after the ~13:00 Nozomi into Shinagawa, check-in from 15:00. Ask for: exact address, check-in code, whether they will receive forwarded luggage (decides the luggage plan), Haneda advice, and that the second bedroom is a real room.

03**書類****PAPERWORK****7****Photo of your passport photo page into the bookings folder** 2分**Chase Dad for his passport photo** 2分

you need it for Visit Japan Web.

Travel insurance 20分

18 Sep – 5 Oct, hiking cover, cancellation cover (Henn na 17 Sep, Yui-an 20 Sep, MOUNTAinn 21 Sep still cancellable). Dad's list says he arranges his own — agree who buys what; save policy number + 24h line; send Dad the details.

Visit Japan Web — register both of you 25分

immigration + customs for both; screenshot both sets of QR codes; SEND DAD HIS to save in Photos (it is not on his printed list — remind him).

→ services.digital.go.jp/en/visit-japan-web/

Passports — yours in date; both photocopied 5分

a paper copy of each photo page in your case, separate from the passports.

→ www.gov.uk/foreign-travel-advice/japan

Check the China connection with Air China 15分

connection time and airport; bags checked through to KIX; current airside transit rules for UK passports (visa-free transit has applied — reconfirm, do not assume).

→ www.airchina.co.uk/

Prescriptions 15分

repeat prescriptions filled — 18 days + spare, original boxes, a copy of each prescription in the hand luggage. Nothing on the Japan restricted list (codeine, pseudoephedrine).

teamLab Borderless — Sun 4 Oct, 10:30–11:00 slot 10分

buy now; not the 10:00.

→ www.teamlab.art/e/borderless-azabudai/

Haru Cooking Class — Mon 21 Sep 13:00 10分

email: does he run on the holiday? Your veg course ¥7,700 + Dad ¥9,800. Fallback: airKitchen Asakusa 3 Oct.

→ www.kyoto-cooking-class.com/

Saihō-ji, the Moss Temple — decide, book if wanted (24 Sep) 10分

advance booking only, capped numbers. Otherwise Gio-ji, no booking.

→ saihoji-kokedera.com/en/

SHELTER 35th-anniversary gig — pick a night 1–4 Oct 10分

check eplus for the 1/2/4 Oct acts (LINK + VENUS PETER already on Sat 3 Oct). Door entry usually possible.

→ eplus.jp/sf/venue/1550160/events

Top up Suica in Apple Wallet to ~¥3,000 3分**Order the Bluetooth audio splitter + USB-C → 3.5 mm adaptor** 5分

e.g. Twelve South AirFly Duo. Skip if you are both on AirPods.

Your own eSIM 10分

~20 GB / 18 days. Install, test with Wi-Fi off. Dad is sorting his own data.

→ saily.com/

Enable 3-D Secure on the card you will use for Japanese sites 5分

Shibuya Sky needs it on the 18th.

Update the Spend Master 3分

Kiso second base is MOUNTAinn Nagiso, booked, £422.

任意 Tower of the Sun interior — 22 Sep

no on-the-day entry.

→ taiyounotou-expo70.jp/

任意 Yusai-tei time slot — 24 Sep

only if the Plan B+ cluster is used.

Monday to Thursday, before we fly on Friday 18 September.

01

ホテル

HOTEL MESSAGES — ARRIVALS + TRANSFERS

1

Trains booked → reply to each with the confirmed times 15分

one line each. Then tick the whole stage.

02

体験

EXPERIENCES TO BOOK

3

Go-karts in Tokyo — book the drive 15分

Street Kart, Shibuya or Akihabara; pick the day (2 or 3 Oct). Needs the IDP below. On the day: passport + UK licence + IDP.

→ kart.st/

International Driving Permit for the go-karts 20分

1949 IDP, £5.50 at a PayPoint shop, issued on the spot; impossible once in Japan. Dad too if he drives.

→ www.paypoint.com/instore-services/international-driving-permits

Book any tours or guides 30分

the Osaka guided element (Kuromon food tour or Shinsekai walk) and anything else you want led rather than wandered.

→ www.getyourguide.com/

03

スマホ

PHONE SET-UP

6

Register the Suica in SmartEX 5分

so you both tap through the Shinkansen gates.

→ smart-ex.jp/en/index.php

Website — finish, publish, on both phones, tested 60分

final content in; drag the site folder to Netlify (same URL), bump the sw version; Add to Home Screen on both phones; open every page on Wi-Fi; airplane-mode test.

→ app.netlify.com/drop

Films onto the iPad for both flights 20分

nothing streams in the air.

Bookings folder — PDFs of everything, shared with Dad, offline 20分

flights, all seven beds, trains, classes, shows, insurance; QR screenshots.

Emergency contacts card — save it, send Dad a copy 10分

insurer 24h line + policy no.; UK Embassy Tokyo +81 3-5211-1100; 110 police / 119 ambulance; every hotel's number; Yui-an/MOUNTAINn +81 264-40-1001.

Dietary cards tested full-screen on both phones 3分

Phrases page — yours (no meat) and Dad's.

Luggage plan 28 Sep → 1 Oct — decide one 10分

1: Yamato Henn na → the flat on the 28th, only if U Place confirm in writing. 2: Yamato centre near Shimokitazawa, collect 1 Oct. 3: carry (Shinano has space, Yui-an collect by car, taxi from Shinagawa) — the default if nobody replies.

→ www.kuronekoyamato.co.jp/en/

Book the bag transfers 10分

once decided: Yamato TA-Q-BIN — the Henn na desk writes the slip; ~¥2,500–3,000 per case; allow 2 days.

Luggage tags with Henn na's Japanese address, printed 5分

on the website, 19 Sep page.

Bank + cards 5分

tell the bank the dates; take the fee-free card.

Yen cash for landing 10分

¥30–40k — draw by 18 Sep. Bank counters shut 19–23 Sep for Silver Week; 7-Eleven ATMs do not.

Agree the money plan with Dad 15分

budget page: A — he transfers his share of bookings before we fly, split on the ground; B — he pays for everything in Japan and tops up the difference.

Google Maps — download the five offline areas 10分

Kyoto · Osaka · Amanohashidate–Ine · Kiso Valley · Tokyo.

→ maps.google.com/

Google Translate — Japanese pack + camera mode tested on a menu photo 5分

→ translate.google.com/

Japan Travel by NAVITIME 5分

live rail routing with delays — the Kiso rail day and every change.

→ japantravel.navitime.com/en/

GO taxi 5分

the Haneda run and late nights. Card registered.

→ go.goinc.jp/en/

S.RIDE taxi (backup) 3分

when GO shows nothing nearby.

→ www.sride.jp/

tenki.jp — weather 3分

the one that carries JMA typhoon warnings properly.

→ tenki.jp/

SmartEX app 5分

Shinkansen tickets; QR or the registered Suica at the gate.

→ smart-ex.jp/en/index.php

Air China app — booking loaded 5分

→ www.airchina.co.uk/

British Airways app — BA6 loaded 5分

→ www.britishairways.com/

eSIM provider's app 3分

data left, top-ups.

Google Sheets — Spend Master available offline 3分

Sheets app → the sheet → ⋮ → Make available offline.

Google Drive / Files — bookings folder offline 3分**TableCheck** 3分

restaurant bookings (HANTEI, DAWN).

→ www.tablecheck.com/en/

Tabelog 3分

the ratings locals use.

→ tabelog.com/en/

任意 **Klook** 5分

Tokyo Subway Ticket, cheaper than buying there; no JR lines.

→ www.klook.com/

Air China online check-in — Thu 17 Sep from 12:35 10分

seats together, boarding passes offline, both bags declared.

→ www.airchina.co.uk/

任意 **Asakusa sumo show + chanko lunch — 3 Oct**

1-3 weeks ahead; fish/veg chanko for you. If Osaka's Hirakuza shows 22 Sep open, book there instead — one show only.

→ www.viator.com/tours/Tokyo/Challenge-Sumo-Wrestlers-and-Enjoy-a-Chanko-Lunch/d334-13441P51

任意 **HANTEI, Nezu — kushiage omakase lunch, Sat 3 Oct ~12:30**

TableCheck/OpenTable; Saturday lunch so book now. Notes: no meat for Mica; ask whether the frying oil is vegetable only. ~¥3,630 pp.

→ www.tablecheck.com/en/hantei-nezu

任意 **Rihga Royal Osaka lounge window seat — 22 Sep**任意 **Katana dojo (Bizenkai via GetYourGuide) — 3 Oct**

code TRAVELMOREWITHLUCY5 quoted for 5% off.

任意 **Verify the date-locked options**

Oedo Antique Market + Tomioka Hachiman on Sun 4 Oct; Toji Kobo-ichi hours 21 Sep; Tokyo Tower Diamond Veil Thu 1 Oct; Gigamart at Azabudai still running?; Kibune kawadoko season end.

もうすぐ！

出発前リスト・NEXT WEEK

Jobs that can only be done once we have landed. Keep this one in the day bag.

01

飛行機

FLIGHT CHECK-IN

1

BA6 online check-in — Sun 4 Oct from 13:05 JST 10分

from the flat; T3 at Haneda.

→ www.britishairways.com/

02

日本で

IN JAPAN — DATED JOBS

7

Shibuya Sky — book the 2 Oct ~16:45 slot on 18 Sep

opens exactly 14 days ahead: the morning of the 18th at home or at Gatwick. 3-D Secure card.

→ www.shibuya-scrabble-square.com/sky/

Collect the tickets

HARUKA at the KIX machine on landing (reservation no. + PIN + card + passports); the four e5489 trains at a green JR-West machine, Kyoto Station, 19 Sep.

HOSHINOYA at check-in — 23 Sep

Morning Stretch (8 places) + in-room asa-nabe breakfast for the 24th — both open one day ahead. Insect-listening hour 18:00 nightly. Dinner: same-day à la carte or Unagiya Hirokawa via the desk.

Ine sea taxi — reconfirm the day before, 25 Sep
Avatar Robot Cafe DAWN — 4 Oct

TableCheck 1-2 weeks ahead (20-27 Sep); OriHime Diner, min 2; check the closure calendar.

→ dawn2021.orylab.com/en/

Kiso rail day prep — 29 Sep evening

screenshot Nagiso / Narai / Kiso-Fukushima / Agematsu timetables. Ask hosts about a half-day lift → Atera Valley.

→ global.jr-central.co.jp/en/info/timetable/

Airport taxi to Shinagawa — 5 Oct 08:45

GO app 1-2 days ahead, precise pickup pin; then Keikyu to Haneda T3.

→ go.goinc.jp/en/

到着！

出発前リスト · LATER

MICA · PACKING LIST

Checked case BAGS

Own checked case ≤23 kg, ≤158 cm total (also under the 160 cm Shinkansen rule); leave a quarter empty

EMPTY packable duffel the second checked bag home on BA — omiyage, knives, ceramics

Fold-flat tote

Checked case CLOTHES

Kyoto 24–30°C humid · Tokyo 22–26°C · Kiso mornings 12–16°C · laundry 19–22 Sep, 27 Sep, 1–4 Oct

3 city sets

2 inn-evening sets + good socks floor seating; socks on show

1 smarter outfit + light knit

2–3 favourite outfits Japan dresses up

Trail kit for 29 Sep walking trousers, quick-dry top

Light jumper or fleece

Rain shell

Light sleepwear

Swimwear

Underwear + socks ×7–8

Second shoes that can get wet

Checked case TOILETRIES + KIT

Toiletries >100 ml deodorant from home

Quick-dry towel

Hand towel + tissues

Nail clippers

Laundry bag + detergent pods

Insect repellent + sunscreen

Compact umbrella

Type-A plug adaptors ×2

Spare sketchbooks + pens

Host gifts something small from Norwich for Yui-an and MOUNTAinn

Luggage tags with Henn na's Japanese address

Cabin bag EVERYTHING THAT MUST NOT BE LOST

≤5 kg on Air China. It becomes the 4-night bag for Arashiyama + Ine (see the mini-trip page)

Passport + paper copies of both passports

Phone + charging cable

Cards + yen + coin purse

Medication + prescription copies

Glasses + spare pair + prescription

One change of clothes

20,000 mAh power bank + cables must fly in the

cabin

Headphones

Bluetooth splitter + USB-C → 3.5 mm adaptor

iPad with the films on it

First-aid plasters, blister care, painkillers, antihistamine, bite cream, motion-sickness tablets

Printed booking copies + this list

Offline PDFs + QR screenshots on the phone

Meal-safe snacks

Empty water bottle

Lip balm, eye drops, earplugs + eye mask

A light layer for the plane

Sketchbook + pens

Pen

One book

Day bag, folded flat worn every day from the 19th

MICA · MINI-TRIP PACKING

Take this page with you — pack these from the suitcase on the day.

4-night bag ARASHIYAMA + INE, 23-27 SEP

The big cases stay at Henn na. Pack the cabin bag from the suitcase on the morning of the 23rd. Bus limit: one bag each, ≤1 m total, ≤10 kg.

1 city set

1 inn-evening set + good socks

The smarter outfit + knit

1 favourite outfit

Swimwear HOSHINOYA and Ine private baths

Light sleepwear yukata provided — pack if you prefer your own

Underwear + socks ×4

Rain shell + light jumper

Mini toiletries

Medication for 5 days + prescription copy

Glasses + spare

Chargers + power bank

Sketchbook + pens

One book

Passport, cards, yen

Phone with offline maps + QR screenshots

Confirmations for HOSHINOYA + Miyabi

Insect repellent + sunscreen river valley and the sea

Hand towel + tissues

Day bag + fold-flat tote

Kiso walking-day daypack TUE 29 SEP

Magome → Tsumago, about 3 hours. Bags go ahead to MOUNTAInn by car. 12-16°C at the start, 25°C by lunch.

Water each

Trail snacks

Rain shell

Fleece or jumper packs away by lunch

Cap + sunscreen

Blister plasters

Hand towel + tissues

Small cash tea-house donation, gohei-mochi, ¥300 bus back from Tsumago

Phones charged + offline map of the Kiso Valley

Sketchbook + pen

Kyoto reset night 27-28 SEP

Back at Henn na with the big cases.

Laundry: everything from the 4-night bag

Repack the cabin bag for Kiso, 28 Sep – 1 Oct trail kit, 2 city sets, inn set, layers — cases go by the luggage plan